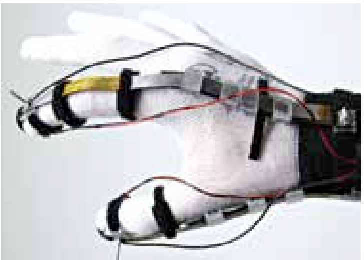
DextrES

When it comes to VR, getting the feeling right has been difficult. From startups to major corporations, reproducing real-world sensations in VR has been elusive. Scientists from EPFL and ETH Zurich have come up with DextrES, a device that claims to have made some major progress in achieving the touch sensation, especially kinesthetic feedback, from the virtual world for your fingers.



The haptic glove is quite lightweight, weighing less than 8 grams per finger. The way it works is pretty interesting. There's a pair of metallic strip-like plates for each finger that is connected to the power source. Usually, these plates are free to move over each other and allow free movement. However, when you touch or grab an object in the virtual world, the glove causes the metallic strips of the finger to snap together using a voltage difference and prevent movement using a braking force, creating a sensation of physical interaction.

According to the researchers, the glove is able to generate up to 40 Newtons of force only requiring 200 Volts and a few milliwatts of power to do so. This enables it to simulate sensations ranging from a hard rock to a soft paper cup while being powered through portable means. The 2mm thickness also allows for high precision. Researchers have already started working on more advanced prototypes that improve the feedback quality as well as cover areas beyond your fingers.

Jabra X Mic

Since action cameras arrived on the scene not too long ago, the way we experience adventure sports, races, and a host of other exciting yet dangerous activities in challenging environments has been transformed. Even an average family holiday today has a unique perspective to add to its albums thanks to the GoPro someone packed. However, in all of these captures, a distinct aspect remains lacking in impact – audio. To change that, Jabra, along with energy drink company Red Bull, has come up with the Jabra X Mic. The audio company has designed a microphone that works well in extreme environments to add that missing dimension to action-cam videos. According to Red Bull, the Jabra team has tested the mic in all kinds of extreme environments, like on mountain bike ridden down a ski slope, on wakeboarders, and even on a KTM X-Bow speeding on a racetrack in Austrian rain. The mic is a custom creation which features signature fabric designed to reduce mic noise. The brand also intends to test it on skydivers, and even astronauts in outer space. The main components include a digital signal processing unit that distinguishes between wind noise and what you want to hear, as well as the wireless connectivity. It is also capable of synchronising between multiple mics and comes with a mount that is suitable for various kinds of surfaces.

Pyua

Gamers and nostalgia are often seen hand in hand. In fact, if you get a chance to go through our SKOAR archives, you'll find a lot of articles about the good old years of gaming. If you still need more proof, check out how many remastered games and relaunched retro consoles have come about in the last few years. However, if you want to take your love for nostalgia in gaming to a level where only a few can reach, let us introduce you to the Pyua.

Best described as a Nintendo shrine, Swedish designer Love Hultén's creation keeps in line with his style of blurring the distinction between technology and art. Built as a tribute for Nintendo, the Pyua is also compatible as a platform with the classic NES and Famicom cartridges, powered by the Nt mini PCB. The Pyua supports 1080p output via an HDMI cable and comes with NES wireless controllers sporting a custom design from 8bitdo. It also claims to have no degradation or input lag whatsoever.

Don't expect to own one any time soon, or maybe ever. Holten only sometimes accepts commision work for his designs. In case you ever do get it, you'll have a display case-cum-console as well as a custom storage case for your cartridges, also designed by Holten.